MENTORSHIP PROGRAM · WORKBOOK 01

The Trading Journal System

Daily · Weekly · Monthly

A guided framework for turning your screen time into written evidence — and your written evidence into rules you can actually trade.

01	**DAILY**	Capture the plan, the execution and the truth about both — while it is still fresh.
02	**WEEKLY**	Convert repeated mistakes into written rules, then backtest the same week against them.
03	**MONTHLY**	Audit wins, losses and behaviour — then compare against last month to prove improvement.

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How this system works

Most traders "journal" by screenshotting a win and moving on. That is a scrapbook, not a journal. This system is built as three connected layers, and each layer feeds the next one. If you skip a layer, the one above it has nothing to work with.

LAYER	WHEN	WHAT IT PRODUCES
Daily	Before & after every session	Raw data — your plan, your trades, your mistakes and your emotional state, recorded before memory rewrites them.
Weekly	Saturday or Sunday	Rules — patterns pulled out of five days of raw data, written as testable "if / then" statements and backtested on that same week.
Monthly	Last day of the month	A verdict — what is repeatable, what is leaking money, and the one or two changes you commit to next month.

The six ground rules

01 **Journal the same day, before you sleep.** Memory decays within hours. The emotional truth — why you actually clicked — decays even faster.

02 **Screenshot every trade.** Mark your entry, your stop, your target and the level or footprint that justified it. No screenshot, no entry in the journal.

03 **Write what you saw, not what you wish you saw.** Nobody else has to read this. The moment you start writing for an audience, the journal stops being useful.

04 **Separate process from outcome.** A loss taken exactly by the model is a *good* trade. A win taken outside the model is a *bad* trade that got paid. Grade both honestly.

05 **Never skip a red day.** The days you least want to write about carry the most information. That is the entire point of the red-day checklist.

06 **Reviews are not optional.** The daily journal only collects evidence. The weekly and monthly reviews are where that evidence becomes an edge.

How to use this workbook
Sections 1–3 explain each layer and what a strong answer looks like. At the end of each section you will find a blank template you can copy into Notion, Obsidian, a spreadsheet or a paper notebook — whatever you will actually open every day. The tool does not matter. The consistency does.

Part A — The pre-market plan

Written **before** the session opens. This is the document your post-session notes will grade you against, so it has to be specific enough to be wrong.

1. Higher-timeframe context

Is price balanced or imbalanced? Where are we relative to yesterday's value area, the overnight range and the weekly open? What did the last session leave unfinished?

2. Levels that matter today

List them — and next to each one, write *why* it matters. A level without a reason is decoration.

3. Scenarios, written as if / then

Two or three at most. `"If price opens inside balance and rejects the high → I look for a short on the retest, not the break."` If you cannot write the scenario as a sentence, you do not have a plan — you have a bias.

4. News & event risk

Time-stamped. Decide *now* whether you trade through it, before it, or not at all.

5. Risk parameters for the day

Risk per trade, maximum trades, maximum daily loss, and the point at which you close the platform. Numbers, not feelings.

6. State check — 1 to 10

Sleep, stress, and whether you are carrying anything from yesterday's session. Below a 5, size down or sit out. This single line will explain more of your bad days than any chart ever will.

The test of a good plan: if you handed it to another trader in the mentorship, could they trade your session without asking you a single question? If not, it is not finished.

Part B — Trade breakdown

One block per trade, every trade — winners, losers and scratches. Repeat this block as many times as you traded.

TRADE 01 Setup name: _____ Result: _____ R

Insert the chart screenshot here — entry, stop, target and the level that justified them

Reasoning & logic

What was the setup, and what confirmed it? Context, level, order flow, effort vs result, and how it tied back to the pre-market plan. Be specific enough that you could recognise this exact condition again six months from now.

Result vs expectation

What actually happened, and did it behave the way the model says it should? A trade can hit target and still behave wrong — note that when it happens.

Mistakes & improvement

Entry timing, sizing, management, exit. Could this execution have been better, or was it clean? "No mistakes" is a valid answer — but only if it is true.

Grade every trade on process, not P&L

A — By the model, well executed.
B — By the model, sloppy entry or exit.
C — Marginal setup, forced.
D — Outside the model entirely.

Track the grade next to the R. When your A-grades are profitable and your C and D grades bleed, you no longer need convincing — you have proof.

Daily scorecard

TRADES	WINS	LOSSES	NET R	RULE BREAKS	GRADE (A–D)	STATE 1–10

Part C — The red-day checklist

Complete this **only on days you close negative**. Four questions, answered honestly, will tell you whether you had a bad day or a bad process — and those two require completely different responses.

[ ] 1. Am I losing more today than I made on my last profitable day?
If yes, the problem is asymmetry, not accuracy. One red day should never erase several green ones. Check size and check how long you stayed in the seat.

[ ] 2. Did I execute the setups following the model?
If yes — this was a cost of doing business, and you owe yourself nothing. If no, name the exact deviation. "I was impatient" is not a deviation; "I entered on the break instead of waiting for the retest" is.

[ ] 3. Can I blame myself for risk management?
Did you oversize, add to a loser, move a stop, revenge trade, or take more trades than your plan allowed? This is the question that separates a drawdown from a blow-up.

[ ] 4. Am I comfortable enough to go to sleep calm?
If not, write down exactly what is keeping you up. Nine times out of ten it is not the money — it is a rule you know you broke. Name it here and it becomes next week's rule.

The verdict — write one line

Good process, bad outcome.
Model followed, risk respected, market simply did not pay. No change required. Do not "fix" anything — that is how a clean strategy gets destroyed.

Bad process.
One or more rules broken. This day goes straight into the weekly review as raw material for a new rule. Write the specific trigger, not the emotion.

Corrective action for tomorrow (one only): e.g. no trades in the first 10 minutes; maximum two setups; hard stop after −2R.

Part D — Post-session notes

Written after the close, on every day — green, red or flat. This is where the day gets scored against the plan you wrote before it started.

1. How accurate was my pre-market plan? ___ / 10

Did the market do what you expected? Which scenario played out, and which one did you not even consider? Being wrong here is fine and useful. Being vague is not.

2. How much of my plan did I actually follow? ___ / 10

These two scores are the most important numbers in the whole journal. A high accuracy score with a low adherence score means you can read the market and cannot follow yourself — that is an execution problem, and it is fixable in weeks. The reverse is a strategy problem, and it takes longer.

3. Overall thought process after the session

Free writing. What the session felt like, where you hesitated, where you were sharp, what you noticed about the market that is not in your model yet. Three to five honest sentences beat a page of tidy ones.

4. Add / remove / consider for tomorrow

One thing to **add**, one thing to **remove**, one thing to **watch**. Keep it to three — anything longer is a wish list, not an adjustment.

METRIC	TODAY	NOTE
Plan accuracy (1–10)		
Plan adherence (1–10)		
Net R for the day		
Rules broken		
Best decision of the day		
Worst decision of the day		

Track adherence, not P&L. Your daily profit is largely outside your control. Your adherence score is entirely inside it. Chart the adherence score across a month — that curve is the one that predicts the equity curve.

SECTION 01 · COPY THIS

Daily journal — blank template

Copy this structure into whatever tool you use. Repeat the trade block for each trade taken.

```
DATE: _____   SESSION: NY   INSTRUMENT: _____

— PRE-MARKET PLAN —
HTF context (balanced / imbalanced, prior value, overnight): .....
Key levels + why they matter: .....
Scenario A — IF ..... THEN .....
Scenario B — IF ..... THEN .....
News / event risk + time: .....
Risk today: ____ per trade  |  max trades ____  |  max daily loss ____
State check (1–10): ____  Notes: .....

— TRADE [ N ] : [ SETUP NAME ] —
[ chart screenshot ]
Reasoning / logic / confirmation: .....
Result vs expectation: .....
Mistakes + how execution could improve: .....
R: ______  |  Process grade: A / B / C / D

— RED-DAY CHECKLIST (negative days only) —
[ ] Am I losing more than my last profitable day? .....
[ ] Did I execute the setups following the model? .....
[ ] Can I blame myself for risk management? .....
[ ] Am I able to sleep calm? .....
Verdict: good process / bad process    Corrective action: .....

— POST-SESSION NOTES —
Plan accuracy (1–10): ____   Why: .....
Plan adherence (1–10): ____   Why: .....
Overall thought process: .....
Tomorrow — ADD: .....  REMOVE: .....  CONSIDER: .....
Net R: ______  |  Rules broken: ______
```

SECTION 02 · WEEKLY REVIEW

From mistakes to rules

At the end of every week, reread all five daily journals in one sitting. You are not looking at P&L. You are looking for **repetition** — the same mistake appearing on Tuesday and Thursday, or the same condition showing up before your best entries.

01 **Read the week end to end.** Highlight every repeated mistake and every repeated win condition. Once is noise. Twice is a pattern. Three times is a rule waiting to be written.

02 **Turn each pattern into a rule.** A rule must be written as a condition plus an action, and it must be specific enough that someone else could apply it to your charts and get the same answer.

03 **Backtest the same week using those rules.** Same days, same charts, replayed — but this time your new rules are in force.

04 **Compare the backtested week against what you actually did.** The gap between the two is the exact cost of your undisciplined behaviour, in R, in writing.

05 **Keep, adjust or retire.** A rule stays in "testing" until it has survived three separate weeks. Only then does it join the model.

What a good rule looks like

Structure rule

```
When price is balanced, prefer entries on the breakout and retest — trade the transition from balance into imbalance, not the middle of the range.
```

Order-flow rule

```
Before executing, when aggressive large trades show on the 1-minute, check effort vs result across more than one 1-minute candle before accepting that one side is truly in control.
```

Your rules will not look like these. These are examples from my own review, born out of my own mistakes. Yours have to come from your daily journals — and they will not all be setup rules. A rule can be a time window ("no entries in the first 10 minutes of the session"), a risk protocol ("stop for the day after two consecutive losses"), or a behavioural rule ("no trade without a written scenario"). If a mistake cost you money twice this week, it has earned a rule.

Backtest & compare

Replay the same week with your new rules applied, then put the two versions side by side. This is the step almost everyone skips, and the one that makes rules stick — because you stop being told discipline pays and start seeing the number.

Rule log

#	RULE (CONDITION → ACTION)	BORN FROM WHICH MISTAKE	STATUS
1			
2			
3			

Status: **Testing** (week 1–3) · **Active** (survived three weeks) · **Retired** (cost more than it saved).

Actual week vs rule-based backtest

METRIC	ACTUAL WEEK	WITH RULES APPLIED	DIFFERENCE
Number of trades			
Win rate			
Net R			
Largest single loss			
Worst drawdown in the week			
Trades that broke a rule			

Three questions to close the week

- Which rule would have saved the most R this week?
- Did any rule filter out a trade that was actually good? (A rule that removes your best trades is a bad rule — adjust it rather than defending it.)
- Which single rule am I committing to for next week, above all others?

Careful: backtesting your own week is easy to fake, because you already know how the session ended. Replay bar by bar, and if you are unsure whether you would really have taken an entry — you would not have. Count it as skipped.

SECTION 02 · COPY THIS

Weekly review — blank template

WEEK OF: _____ DAYS TRADED: ____ NET R: _____

— 1. PATTERNS FROM THE DAILY JOURNALS —

Repeated mistakes: .....

Repeated conditions behind my best trades: .....

Emotional / timing patterns I noticed: .....

— 2. RULES BUILT FROM THIS WEEK —

Rule 1 — WHEN ..... THEN ..... (from: .....)

Rule 2 — WHEN ..... THEN ..... (from: .....)

Rule 3 — WHEN ..... THEN ..... (from: .....)

— 3. BACKTEST OF THIS SAME WEEK WITH RULES APPLIED —

Trades taken: ____ | Trades skipped by rules: ____

Win rate: ____ | Net R: _____ | Largest loss: _____

Notes on the replay: .....

— 4. COMPARISON —

Actual net R: _____ vs Rule-based net R: _____ Difference: _____

What the difference tells me: .....

Rule that would have saved the most: .....

Rule that filtered out a good trade (needs adjusting): .....

— 5. COMMITMENT FOR NEXT WEEK —

The one rule I will not break: .....

Rule status updates — testing / active / retired: .....

Keep a running rule book. Do not rewrite your rules each week from scratch. Maintain one master list, dated, with the status of each rule. After three months you will have something no course can sell you: a model built entirely out of your own documented mistakes.

SECTION 03 · MONTHLY RECAP

Winning trades

Once you have a full month of daily journals and four weekly reviews, sit down and audit the month in three blocks: what won, what lost, and how you behaved. Start with the winners — not to celebrate them, but to find out which part of your edge is actually repeatable.

Which setups made the most impact this month — and are they repeatable?
Rank your setups by net R contribution, not by hit rate. Then ask the harder question of each one: could I define its conditions clearly enough to trade it again next month, or did it depend on a market state that has already passed?

Did I maximise my winning days over my losing days?
Compare total R made on green days against total R lost on red days. Your green days should be meaningfully larger. If they are not, you are cutting winners early, holding losers long, or sizing up on exactly the wrong days.

What did my best trades have in common?
Time of session, market state, level type, order-flow confirmation, how long you waited before entering, your state score that morning. Whatever repeats across your top five trades is the core of your edge — and it belongs in your rule book.

How did these wins affect my confidence and my process?
Did a good run make you sharper, or did it make you sloppy and oversized two days later? Winning streaks damage more accounts than losing streaks do, because nobody inspects them.

TOP SETUPS THIS MONTH	TRADES	WIN RATE	NET R	REPEATABLE?

SECTION 03 · MONTHLY RECAP

Losing trades

Losses are only expensive if you fail to extract anything from them. This block decides whether this month's losses were tuition or waste.

Were my losses within planned risk?
Go through every red trade and check the size against the plan. Did you oversize on any of them? Did you overtrade on specific days? Mark the dates — overtrading almost always clusters around the same triggers.

Did I follow my rules on losing trades?
Split the losses into two piles: rule-following losses and rule-breaking losses. Add up the R in each. The first pile is the cost of your edge. The second pile is the money you paid for nothing.

What patterns show up in my losing trades?
A particular time of the session? A particular day of the week? After a win, or after a loss? On days your state score was below 5? After watching someone else's trade? Find the trigger, because the trigger is what you can control — the loss itself is not.

Did I learn from my losses, or did I repeat the same mistakes?
Compare against last month's recap. If the same mistake appears in both, the problem is no longer knowledge — it is a missing rule or a missing constraint. Build the constraint into your environment, not your willpower.

LOSS CATEGORY	TRADES	TOTAL R LOST	TRIGGER / PATTERN
Rule-following losses			
Rule-breaking losses			
Oversized / overtraded			

The number that matters: total R lost on rule-breaking trades. That figure is your discipline tax for the month. Write it at the top of next month's plan and try to make it smaller. Nothing else in this recap moves an equity curve faster.

SECTION 03 · MONTHLY RECAP

Overall — behaviour & progress

The last block is not about trades at all. It is about the trader. Answer these against **last month**, not against some imaginary standard.

Did my discipline, consistency and mindset improve compared to last month?
Point to evidence, not feeling. Fewer rule breaks, fewer revenge trades, higher average adherence score, fewer days below a 5 on the state check.

Did I follow my rules more this month than last month?
Count the rule breaks in both months and compare directly. This is the single cleanest measure of progress in the entire workbook, because it is immune to whether the market happened to suit you.

Was I consistent with journaling and weekly reviews — and did I act on them?
How many days did you journal out of the days you traded? How many weekly reviews did you complete? And did any rule you wrote actually change your behaviour, or did it just sit in a document?

What one or two changes will I commit to next month?
Two maximum. Specific, measurable, and checkable in thirty days. "Be more patient" fails all three tests. "No entries before 9:45, no more than three trades per session" passes all three.

Month-over-month scoreboard

METRIC	LAST MONTH	THIS MONTH	DIRECTION
Net R			
Win rate			
Avg R on green days vs red days			
Rule breaks			
R lost to rule breaks			
Avg plan adherence (1–10)			
Days journaled / days traded			

SECTION 03 · MONTHLY RECAP

Compare this month against last month

Once you have two months of recaps written, put them side by side and compare your answers to **the same questions**. This is where improvement stops being a feeling and becomes visible. Use an AI assistant for this step — it will spot repetition across two documents faster than you will, and it has no reason to flatter you.

PROMPT — COPY AND PASTE

```
You are my trading performance coach. Below are my monthly journal recaps for [MONTH A]
and [MONTH B], answering the same set of questions.

Compare them and tell me:
1. What measurably improved, with the numbers.
2. What stayed the same or got worse.
3. Which mistakes appear in both months — quote my own words back to me.
4. Which rules I said I would follow but the answers suggest I did not.
5. Whether my stated commitments from [MONTH A] actually showed up in [MONTH B].
6. The one or two highest-leverage changes for next month, ranked.

Be blunt and specific. Do not encourage me for the sake of it. If the evidence says I did
not improve, say so plainly.

--- MONTH A RECAP ---
[ paste ]

--- MONTH B RECAP ---
[ paste ]
```

What to do with the output

01 **Do not accept it at face value.** The AI only sees what you wrote. If your journals are vague, the comparison will be vague. Garbage in, encouragement out.

02 **Look for the repeated mistake first.** Anything appearing in both months is your single highest-priority fix for next month. Everything else waits.

03 **Convert the findings into rules,** using the same condition → action format from the weekly review. A finding that does not become a rule changes nothing.

04 **Save the comparison.** Three of these back to back is the clearest record of development you will ever own as a trader.

Commitments carried into next month

SECTION 03 · COPY THIS

Monthly recap — blank template

MONTH: _____ | DAYS TRADED: ____ | NET R: _____

— WINNING TRADES —

Which setups made the most impact? Are they repeatable? .....

Did I maximise winning days over losing days? (R made on green days vs R lost on red days) .....

What did my best trades have in common? .....

How did these wins affect my confidence and process? .....

— LOSING TRADES —

Were my losses within planned risk? Did I oversize or overtrade on certain days? .....

Did I follow my rules on losing trades? (rule-following R vs rule-breaking R) .....

What patterns show up in my losing trades? (time, day, emotional trigger) .....

Did I learn from my losses, or repeat the same mistakes? .....

— OVERALL —

Did my discipline, consistency and mindset improve vs last month? .....

Did I follow my rules more than last month? (rule breaks: ____ vs ____) .....

Was I consistent with journaling and weekly reviews? ____ / ____ days

What 1–2 changes will I commit to next month? .....

— MONTH VS MONTH —

Run the comparison prompt on last month's recap and this one.

Repeated mistakes found: .....

Commitments from last month I actually kept: .....

Highest-leverage change for next month: .....

REFERENCE

The rhythm & the numbers

Your journaling rhythm

WHEN	TIME NEEDED	WHAT YOU DO
Before the open	10–15 min	Write the pre-market plan. Context, levels, scenarios, risk, state check.
After each trade	2 min	Screenshot and one line of reasoning while it is still fresh. Fill in the rest after the close.
After the close	15–20 min	Trade breakdowns, red-day checklist if negative, post-session notes and scores.
Weekend	60–90 min	Read the week, build rules, backtest the week with them, compare and commit.
End of month	90 min	Full recap, month-over-month comparison, one or two commitments.

Metrics worth tracking

METRIC	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
R multiple	Result of a trade expressed in units of the risk you took. Reporting in R rather than currency keeps the analysis honest across different account sizes.
Expectancy	Average R per trade over a sample. The only number that answers "is this model actually worth trading?"
Profit factor	Gross R won divided by gross R lost. Below 1.0 you are paying the market for the privilege.
Adherence score	How much of your written plan you actually followed. Fully within your control — and it usually leads the equity curve.
Discipline tax	Total R lost specifically on rule-breaking trades. The fastest single number to improve.
Green vs red day ratio	Average R on winning days against average R on losing days. Tells you whether your asymmetry is right way round.

Thirty days from now, the value of this workbook will not be in any single entry. It will be in the pattern that appears when you read a month of them in one sitting — the same mistake, the same hour, the same trigger, in your own handwriting. That is the moment the journal starts paying you back.

COMMITMENT

Consistency beats intensity.

Journal every session you trade, review every week you trade, and recap every month you trade. Do that for ninety days and you will know more about your own edge than any indicator, course or signal group could ever tell you.

My commitment

I will journal every session, complete a weekly review every weekend, and recap every month before starting the next.

Name

Start date